he and his team have over decades developed close relationships with leaders of religious and caste-based organizations—some of these relationships are on display often, whereas some come to light in times like these. National Security Advisor Ajit Doval was deputed to mediate and convince the Tablighi leader to allow the missionaries in the mosque to be evacuated, tested and quarantined. To avoid a scene which would further elevate tensions and garner unnecessary media attention, he made a visit with his team at 2.00 a.m. on the intervening night of 28 March.[31] Although it wouldn't be wise to put out the exact conversation between Doval and Maulana Saad, the actions that followed his visit are very telling. Saad went out of the limelight for the next few weeks, the tapes were taken down and the missionaries lodged in the mosque were allowed to be taken to quarantine centres where they were tested for coronavirus.[32] The future tapes which emerged from the now 'underground' Maulana Saad were significantly more responsible ones, appealing to his followers to follow government directives and laws in an effort to fight the virus in the country.[33] For several months thereafter, Saad remained confined in his home only to resurface in public in June 2020 to offer prayers at a mosque in the national capital.[34]

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Needless to say, for a lockdown of this scale, in the second most populous country in the world, several issues cropped up which required committed firefighting on a daily basis. The PMO along with the empowered groups essentially became a war room. The prime minister's directive to everyone was clear: no issue was too small to warrant our attention. To further describe how accessible he wanted to be, there was an episode around the last week of March when Sakal Media Group's managing director, Abhijit Pawar reached out to the prime minister to offer suggestions on curbing the contagion. As evidenced by the audio leak of their conversation, the prime minister not only took note of his suggestions but also assured him that he'd minutely look into the proposals, adding, '*Mujhe koi jadu ki chari mil jaye toh desh bach jayega mera* (If I can get some kind of a magic wand of this sort, then my country can be saved.)'[35]

In the truest sense, following the prime minister's push, many influential personalities walked the extra mile in contributing to the national